

BREAKING DOWN THE NUMBERS

24

GOVT LAND
PARCELS IDENTI-
FIED IN MUMBAI

12

SQ KM
REDEVELOPMENT
AREA

55

MILLION SQ FT
PLANNED HOUS-
ING POTENTIAL

₹25-97

LAKH
PRICE RANGE

70,000

AFFORDABLE HOMES ALREADY
DELIVERED

38

ACRES
DLF REDEVELOP-
MENT IN WEST
DELHI

26-30

STOREY
RESIDENTIAL
TOWERS

₹2.6 LAKH

MONTHLY RENTAL FOR PREMIUM 3-BHK
HOMES IN ONE MIDTOWN

velopment. The deadline for the project was June 2026. But with unclear policies, and the developer facing financial problems and dealing with the National Company Law Tribunal, the project is progressing at a snail's pace. The relocated residents are struggling in transit camps even after 10 years. However,

thanks to DLF's project, many others such as Raheja Leela and The Sky Villas have evolved into premium lifestyle projects with private pools in every unit, in the same environs. The premium tag for Moti Nagar is now here to stay.

URBAN REGENERATION

Redevelopment can be an effective solution to urban regeneration. The backbone of governance alone can make it succeed every time. Mumbai appears to have got this right with Development Plan 2034, which declares the intent of the city's urbanisation, and makes it easy for the private sector to follow the plug and play model. Organisations such as Modi's Navnirman and Meghna Realty have chosen to stick to redevelopment projects and have even been listed on stock exchanges and remained debt-free.

Maharashtra has spent decades perfecting redevelopment as a tool to unlock the value of premium land that has been encroached on for decades because the city did not plan for its poor. Today, the affordable units are in the same location as the premium ones.

"The buildings that get older are a health risk. There is also a socio-economic gap that gets developed because of the kind of building you're living in," says Krish Sheth, design head of Meghna Realty. "When an old building sits right next to a new building, the kind of gentry between the two buildings is different, and that's what causes a rift in that locality. So, when all the buildings in a lane are redeveloped, the gentry

gets normalised."

Contractor believes that "every Indian deserves to get a good house in a place of his choice." Affordable housing has traditionally been built on city outskirts, increasing travel costs. In Navi Mumbai, the sites were chosen "for their proximity and access to major transit hubs." The houses cost between ₹25 lakh and ₹97 lakh per unit, depending on location and size.

REUSABLE FORMATS

Standard PMAY-compliant models can be reused across locations and states. There is currently a proposal to do something similar in Surat in Gujarat as well.

When private spaces are small, the common areas around have to offer more public space. The houses were in high-rise buildings of 26-30 storeys with square footprints, except where aviation laws restrict them to linear mid-rise buildings. Planned green areas have come up between towers and provide the much-needed environmental relief to residents of small housing units.

Working with the government was a good idea to reduce the cost of units, says C.K. Israni, promoter of the C.K. Israni group that specialises in Engineering, Procurement and Construction government contracts. "Affordable housing is fundamentally driven by efficiency, standardisation, and speed of execution," he says.

The scale of Contractor's projects in high-rises allowed them to aim for economies of scale, allowing premium contracting companies such as